

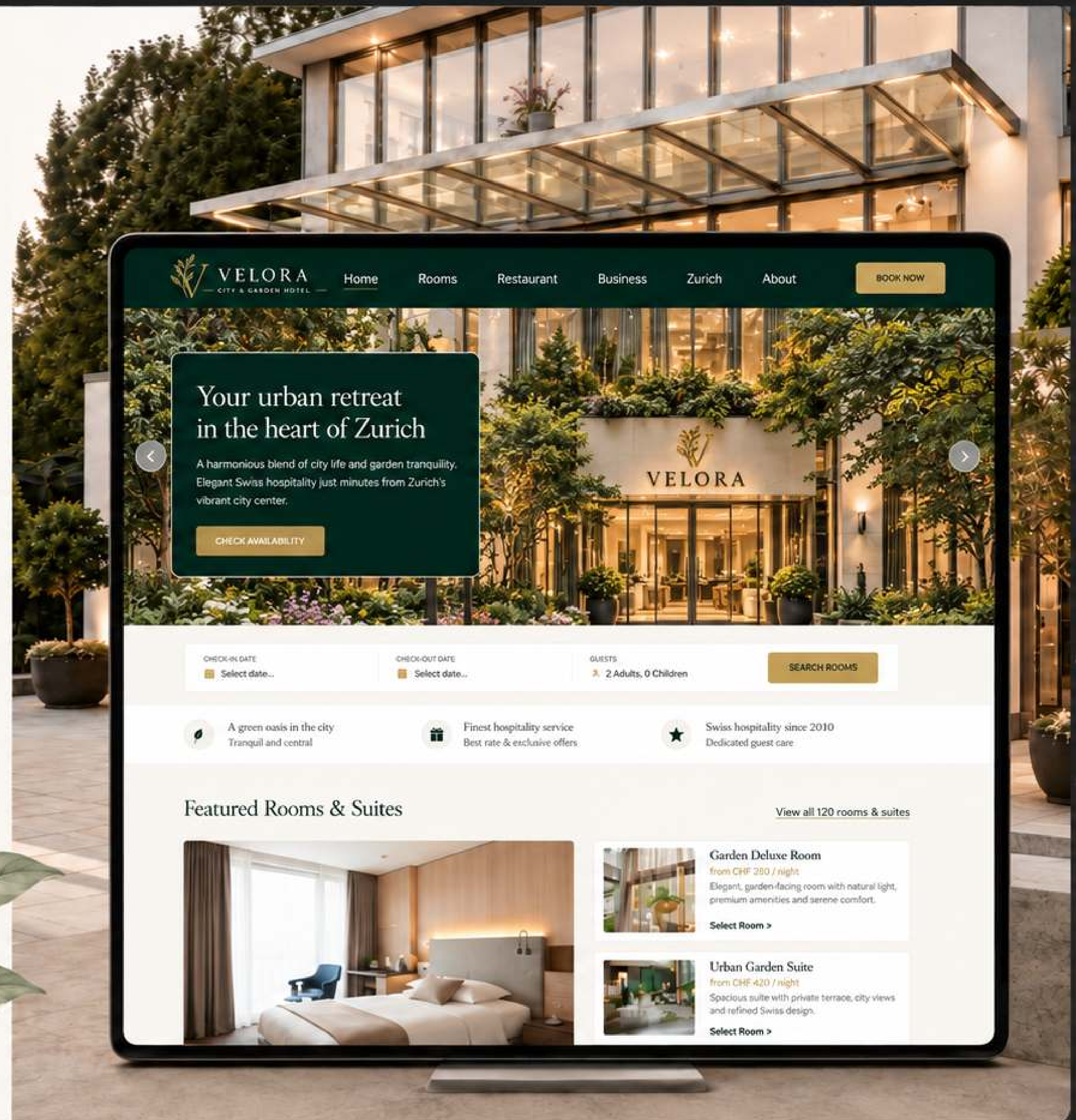


Velora City & Garden Hotel

UX/UI Redesign Case Study

Current experience audit and proposed redesign

Agostina Aldana Boris



Client & Brand Context

Velora City & Garden Hotel is a Zurich-based boutique hotel positioned as an elegant urban retreat surrounded by nature. Its offering combines contemporary accommodation, gastronomy, business facilities and authentic local experiences for both leisure and corporate guests.

The website plays a central role in expressing Velora's distinctive identity and guiding potential guests seamlessly from discovery to direct booking.



LOCATION

Zurich,
Switzerland



AUDIENCE

Leisure &
Business guests



CORE OFFER

Accommodation · Dining ·
Business · Local experiences



MISSION

Create a warm and refined hospitality experience that combines the energy of Zurich with the comfort, calm and character of a garden retreat.

UX IMPLICATION

The digital experience should make essential information easy to discover while communicating elegance, warmth and trust.



VISION

Establish Velora as a distinctive city-and-garden hotel where contemporary hospitality, urban accessibility and nature come together in one memorable experience.

UX IMPLICATION

The website should communicate this differentiation clearly and guide leisure and business guests toward the content most relevant to their needs.

Project Overview

Velora City & Garden Hotel is a boutique urban retreat in Zurich serving both leisure and business guests. This case study evaluates the current website experience and proposes a redesign to improve clarity, content hierarchy and the path toward direct booking.



Challenge

Redesign the full hotel website to improve navigation, content hierarchy, consistency and the overall booking journey across the entire digital experience.



Focus

Navigation, content hierarchy, key guest journeys, room discovery and booking entry points.



Goal

Help potential guests understand Velora's value faster and move more confidently from exploration to booking.

Approach

Evaluative UX audit → prioritization → wireframing → UI redesign



Current Experience

A visually elegant hotel website with strong imagery, but a fragmented path to key information and booking.



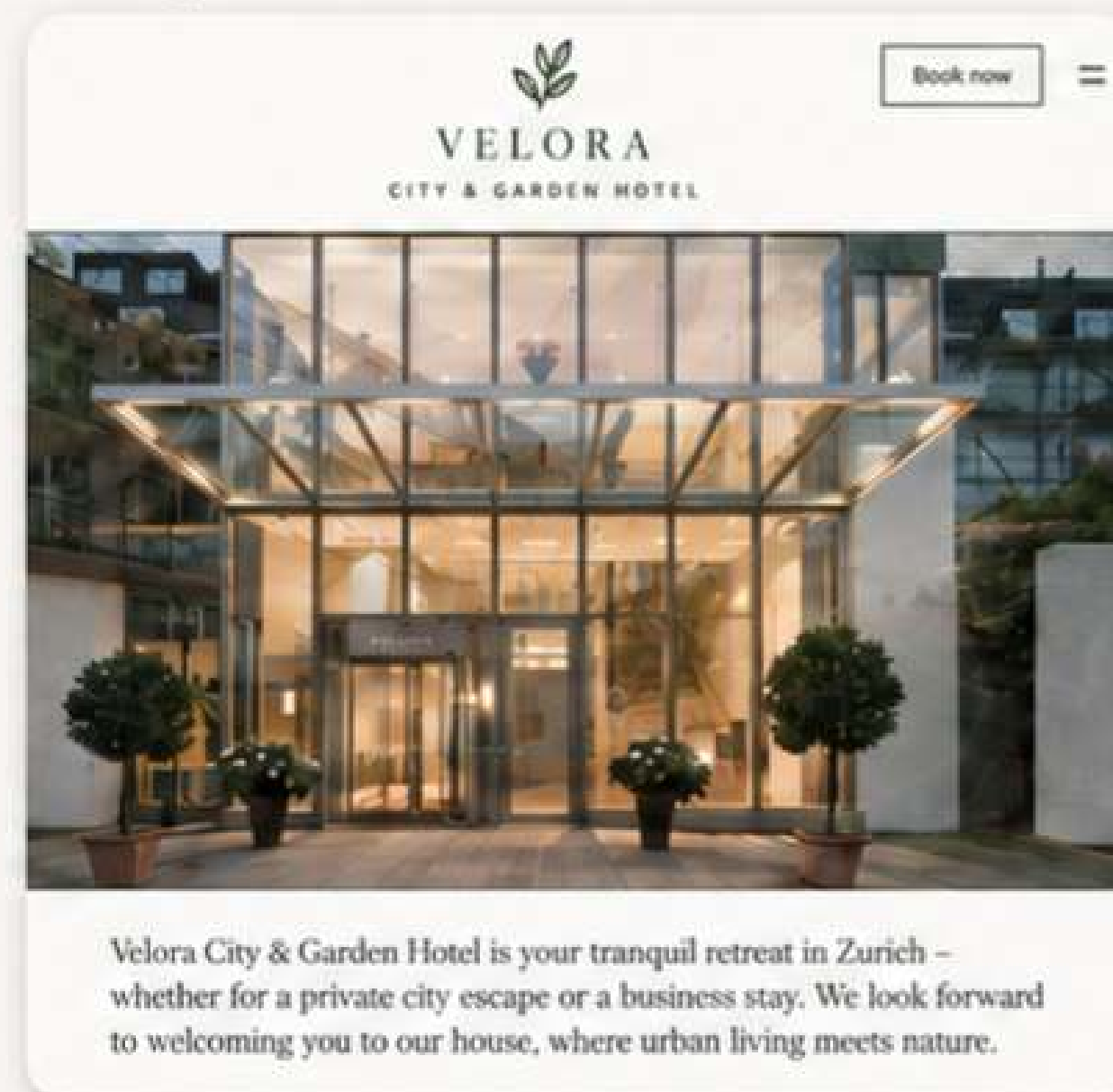
Strong visual identity and premium photography



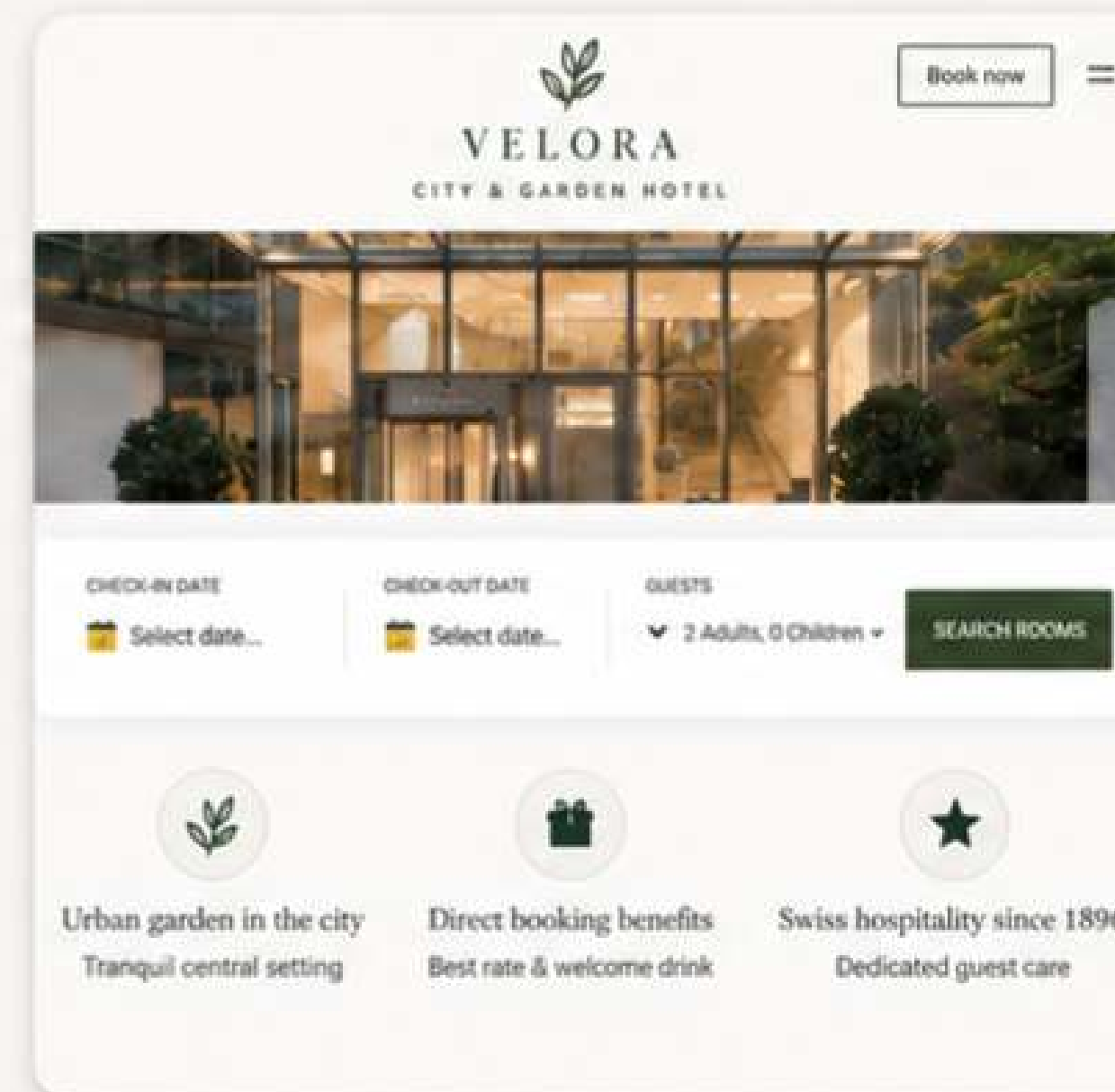
Booking CTA is consistently visible



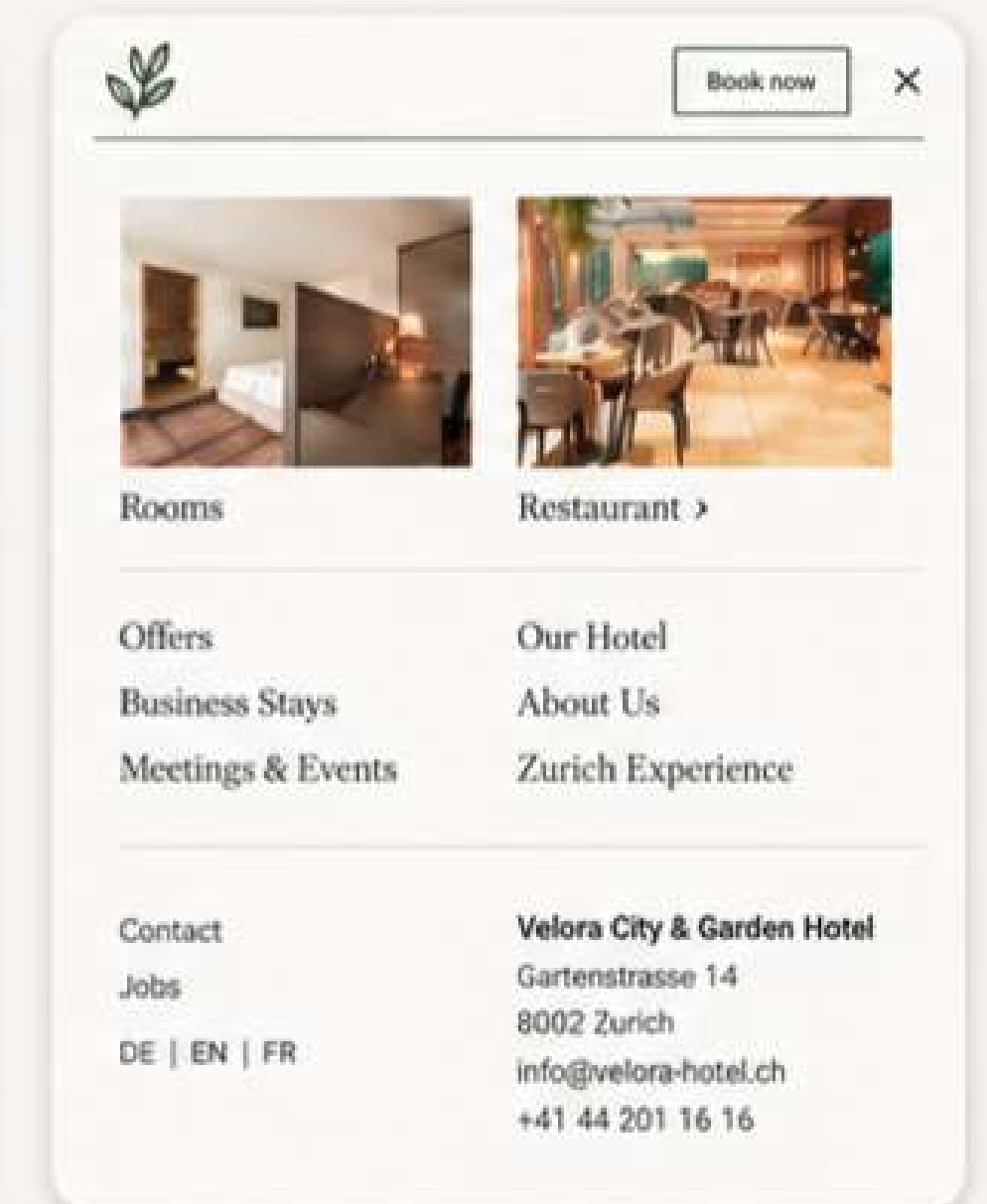
Key information is distributed across several sections and interactions



Hero section



Booking entry point



Menu overlay



UX Strengths

The current website establishes a refined brand presence and already communicates several qualities that support trust and appeal.



1. Strong visual identity

A restrained color palette, serif typography and spacious layout create a calm, elegant and premium atmosphere.



2. High-quality photography

Large, authentic images communicate the hotel's architecture, ambience and green surroundings effectively.



3. Persistent booking CTA

The "Book now" button remains consistently visible across pages, supporting quick access to the primary conversion goal.



4. Rich content offering

The website provides extensive information for leisure and business guests, including rooms, dining, events, seminars and Zurich experiences.



These strengths provide a solid foundation for the redesign and should be preserved and elevated.



UX Weaknesses

The current website presents several usability and content hierarchy issues that create friction and may impact conversion.



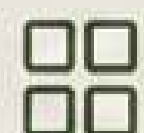
1 Low content discoverability

Much of the information architecture is hidden behind the hamburger menu on desktop, making key sections harder to discover.



2 Excessive page length

Many pages contain long stretches of content that require extensive scrolling to reach relevant information.



3 Flat visual hierarchy

Repetitive, grid-like layouts give many sections similar visual weight and reduce clear focal points.



4 Compact layout & readability

Narrow content containers, tightly stacked modules and limited line spacing make some pages feel visually compressed and harder to read.

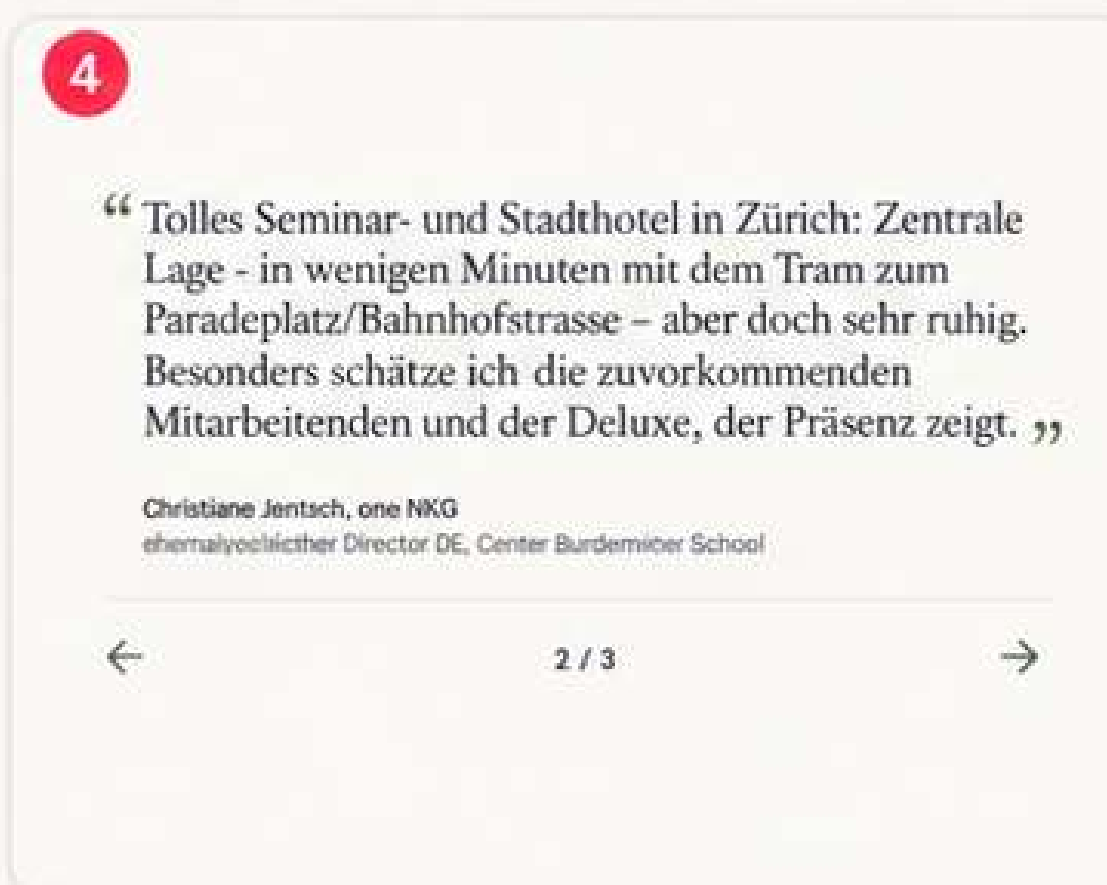
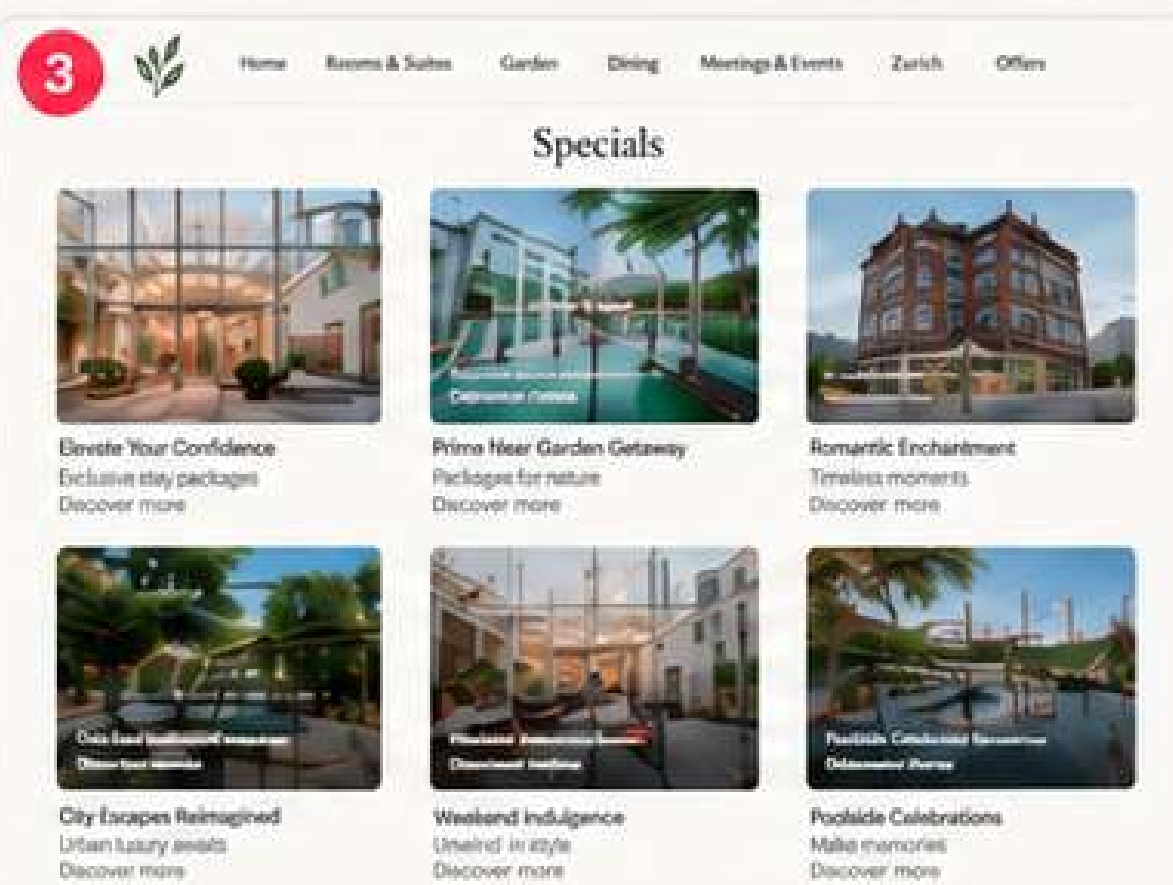


5 Fragmented booking journey

The booking flow feels disconnected from exploration. Users must switch contexts and piece together information before committing, increasing friction in the reservation process.



These issues create friction in the decision-making and booking journey.



Key insight

Users invest too much effort to find, understand and act on the information that matters most. The experience feels dense, long and visually flat, especially at decision points.



Benchmark

To understand what works well in boutique hotel booking experiences, I reviewed selected Zurich hotel websites and compared how they handle navigation, booking visibility, value proposition and content hierarchy.



1 25Hours Hotel Zurich Langstrasse 25hours-hotels.com



✓ Strengths

- Strong brand personality and storytelling.
- Location and neighborhood are communicated early.
- Direct booking CTA stays visible and accessible.

💡 Takeaway

- Show the hotel's personality early.
- Keep the booking path clear while users explore.

2 B2 Hotel Zurich b2hotel.ch



✓ Strengths

- Clear positioning and strong differentiation.
- Information is organized around guest needs.
- The value proposition is communicated immediately.

💡 Takeaway

- Present the hotel's unique value first.
- Group content by user needs to simplify exploration.

3 Greulich Design & Boutique Hotel greulich-designhotel.ch



✓ Strengths

- Strong boutique identity and clean minimal layout.
- Good use of whitespace and hierarchy.
- Rooms and atmosphere feel visually connected.

💡 Takeaway

- Preserve calm visual identity.
- Prioritize sections more clearly.

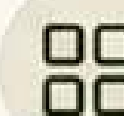
Common patterns observed



Visible
navigation



Clear value
proposition



Organized
content



Accessible
booking path



Benchmark Insights

The comparison shows that high-performing hotel websites do not rely on more content. They rely on better prioritization, discoverability and stronger visual hierarchy.

1



Visible desktop navigation improves discoverability.

2



A strong value proposition above the fold creates a clearer first impression.

3



Better grouping of content simplifies the offer and the decision process.

4



Prominent direct booking keeps the path from exploration to reservation short.

5



More varied visual hierarchy highlights what really matters.

What this means for Velora



Keep the refined visual identity.



Expose rooms, location and booking earlier.



Reduce hidden content and long-scroll fatigue.



Make sections more scannable and easier to compare.



Benchmark takeaway

Velora already has strong visual assets and rich content. The main opportunity is to expose that value more clearly through stronger navigation, content prioritization and visual hierarchy.

Key Frictions & Opportunities

Based on our audit, heuristic analysis and benchmark, we identified the main friction points and the opportunities to elevate the user experience.

! KEY FRICTIONS

 **Navigation is hidden**
The main navigation is tucked inside a hamburger menu on desktop, reducing discoverability and exploration.

 **Value proposition is not clear enough**
The core value of the hotel is not communicated early in the journey.

 **Content hierarchy is inconsistent**
Too many sections compete for attention, making it hard to grasp what is most important.

 **Booking flow feels dense**
The first step of booking shows too much information at once, which can overwhelm users.

 **Visual rhythm is repetitive**
Sections use similar layouts and visual patterns, making the experience feel long and compact.

★ OPPORTUNITIES



Make navigation visible and intuitive

Expose the primary sections to help users explore the offer quickly and confidently.



Strengthen the value proposition

Communicate the hotel's unique blend of calm, nature and hospitality above the fold.



Improve content hierarchy

Prioritize what matters most and guide users through a clear, scannable structure.



Simplify the booking journey

Reduce friction by showing only essential fields in the first step and creating a smoother flow.



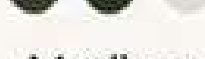
Create more visual variety

Use a richer visual rhythm with varied layouts, media and spacing to keep users engaged.



Prioritization

We prioritized opportunities based on impact for users and feasibility for the business.

OPPORTUNITY		IMPACT FOR USERS <i>High / Medium / Low</i>	BUSINESS FEASIBILITY <i>High / Medium / Low</i>	PRIORITY
1	 Make navigation visible and intuitive Expose the primary navigation on desktop and improve section labeling.	 High	 High	HIGH Do first
2	 Strengthen the value proposition Communicate the hotel's unique blend of calm, nature and hospitality above the fold.	 High	 Medium	HIGH Do second
3	 Improve content hierarchy Prioritize what matters most and guide users through a clear, scannable structure.	 High	 Medium	MEDIUM Plan next
4	 Improve booking entry points Reduce friction in the first booking step and keep only essential fields.	 Medium	 High	MEDIUM Then
5	 Create more visual variety Use varied layouts, media and spacing to create a richer visual rhythm.	 Medium	 Medium	LOW Do later
 PRIORITIZATION INSIGHT Focus first on navigation and value proposition to improve discoverability and clarity, then simplify content and the booking flow to drive conversions.		 HIGH IMPACT Strong positive effect on user experience and engagement.	 MEDIUM IMPACT Positive effect with some limitations or dependencies.	 LOW IMPACT Limited effect on users or not a current priority.

User Archetypes

Three **hypothesis-based** guest archetypes used to guide the redesign.



Anna, 38 — Business Traveler

Travels for meetings and seminars.
Needs efficiency and clarity.



Goals

- Book quickly
- Find room + seminar details
- Stay near meetings



Needs

- Visible amenities
- Fast booking path
- Clear transport details



Frustration

- Too much scrolling and scattered information



Digital Comfort High



Quote

"I need to understand the offer fast and book without second-guessing."



Emma & Leo, 32 & 34 — Leisure Couple

Planning a city break together.
Look for atmosphere and value.



Goals

- Understand hotel atmosphere
- Compare rooms and dining
- Plan a city break



Needs

- Inspiring imagery with clear content
- Easy navigation
- Value clarity



Frustration

- Hidden navigation
- Buried value proposition



Digital Comfort Medium



Quote

"We want to picture the stay quickly and see why this hotel is worth it."



Sofia, 27 — City Explorer

Explores Zurich for short stays.
Values locality and practicality.



Goals

- Check location benefits
- Discover nearby attractions
- Decide quickly



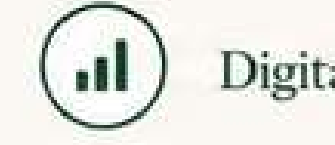
Needs

- Scannable highlights
- Zurich-related content
- Practical tips



Frustration

- Long pages
- Hidden secondary sections



Digital Comfort High



Quote

"If the information is clear and relevant, I can decide in minutes."

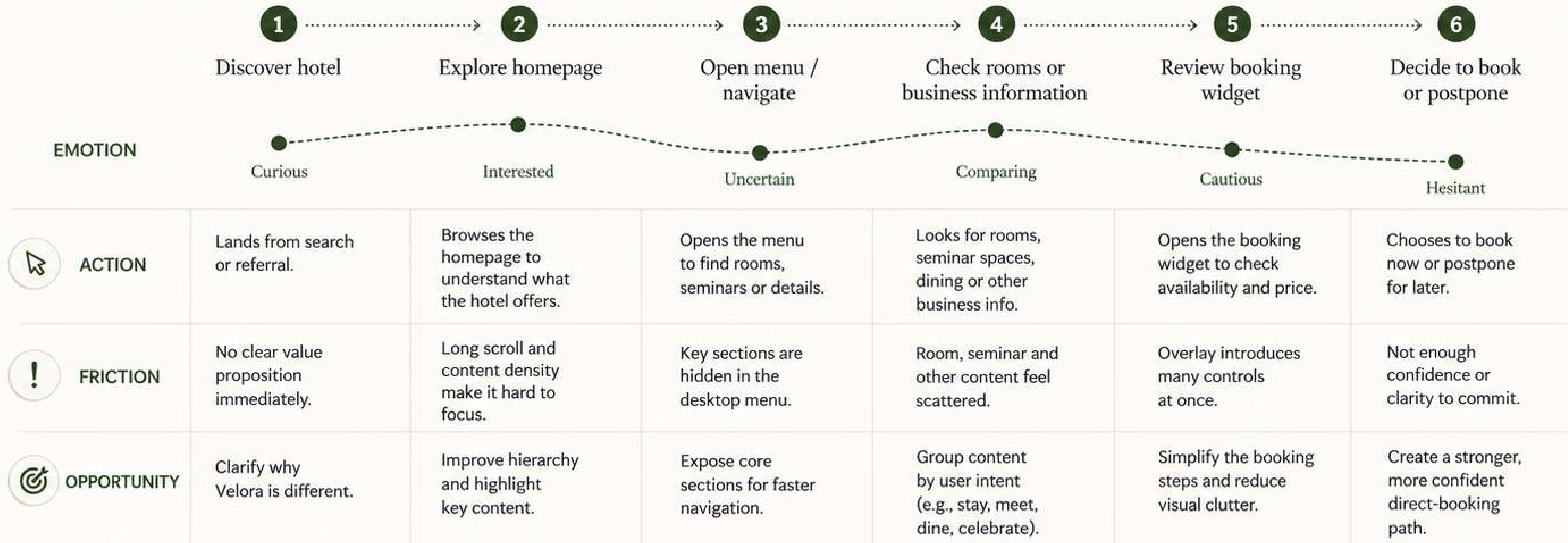


Hypothesis Notice: These archetypes are hypothesis-based and were created from heuristic analysis of the current experience. They are not research-validated personas.

Guest Journey Map

💡 Hypothesis-based current journey

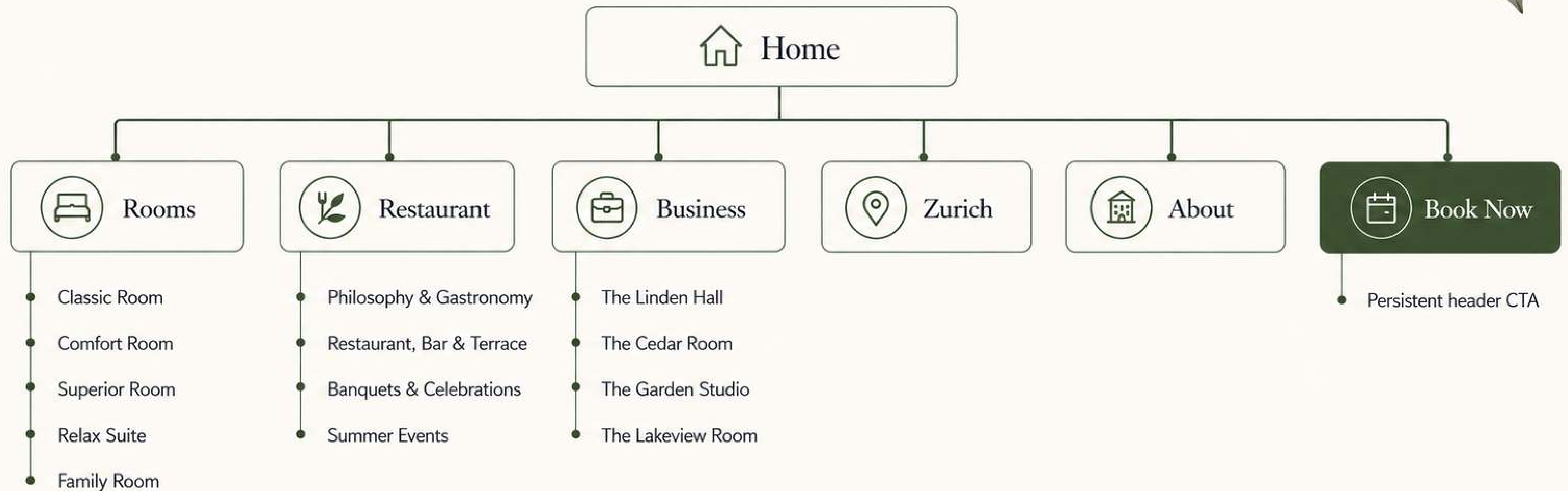
Current path from discovery to booking



Main takeaway: The journey breaks down when content becomes fragmented and the next step is unclear.

Proposed Information Architecture

Reorganizing Velora's content into a clearer, guest-centered structure.



The new structure makes key hotel content visible upfront, keeps section-level navigation clear, and supports faster discovery across rooms, business and dining content.

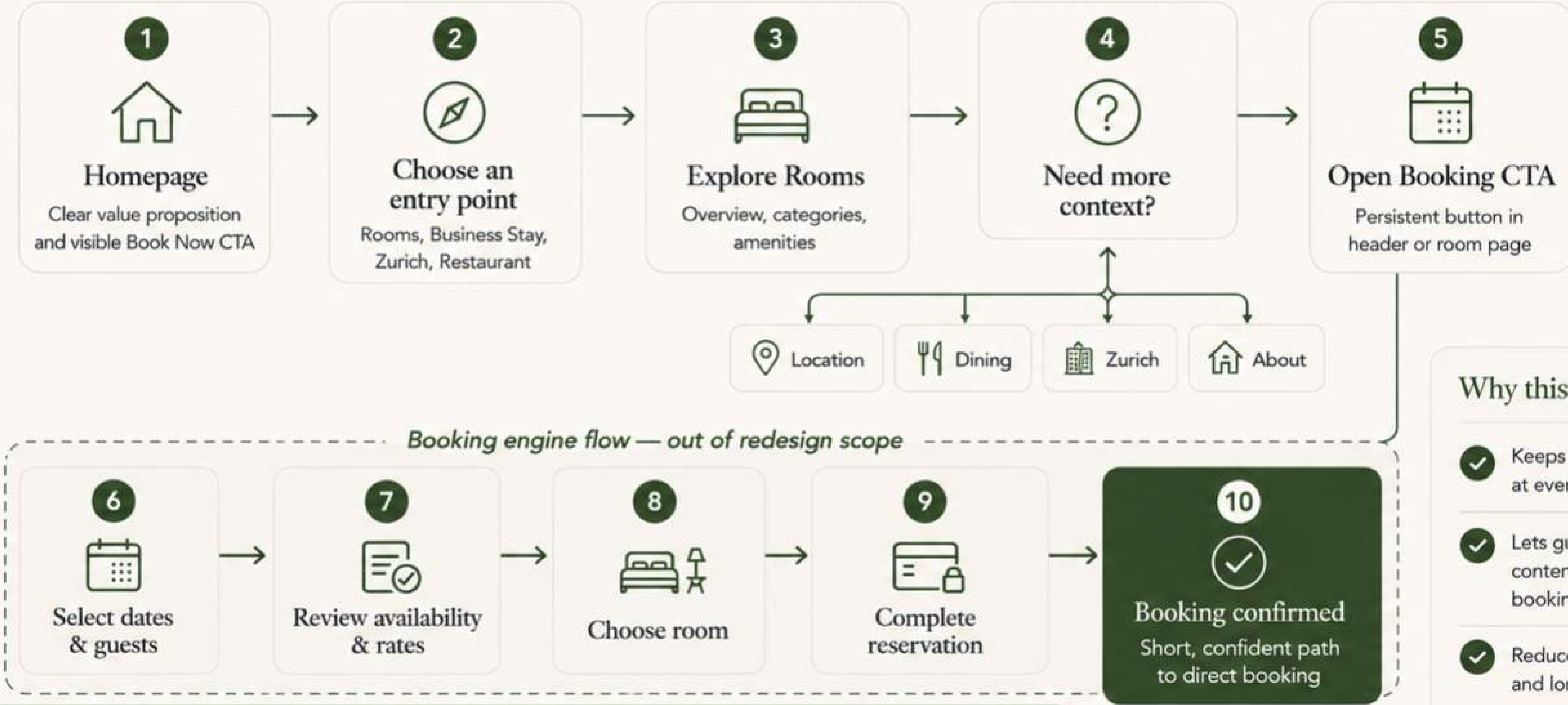
Primary User Flow

Mapping the ideal path from first visit to direct booking.



User goal

Find the right room quickly, understand the hotel offer, and complete a direct booking with confidence.

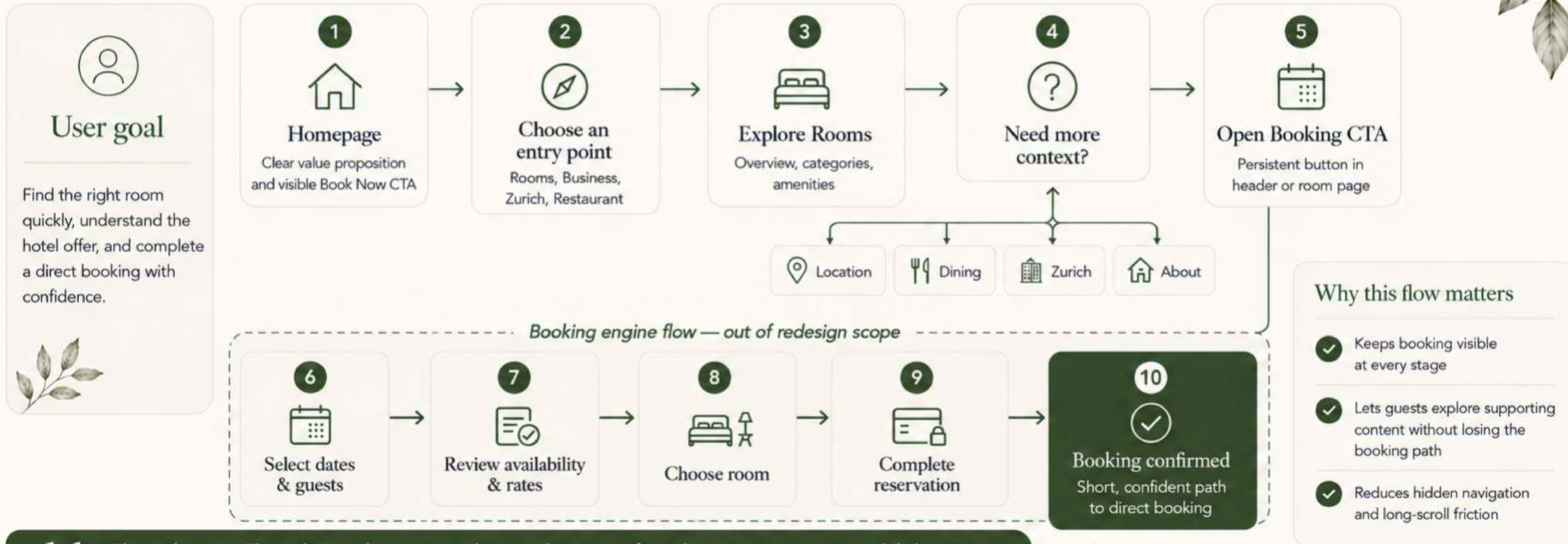
Why this flow matters

- ✓ Keeps booking visible at every stage
- ✓ Lets guests explore supporting content without losing the booking path
- ✓ Reduces hidden navigation and long-scroll friction

Flow takeaway: The redesigned experience shortens the journey from discovery to reservation while keeping supportive hotel content available when guests need reassurance.

Primary User Flow

Mapping the ideal path from first visit to direct booking.



Flow takeaway: The redesigned experience shortens the journey from discovery to reservation while keeping supportive hotel content available when guests need reassurance.

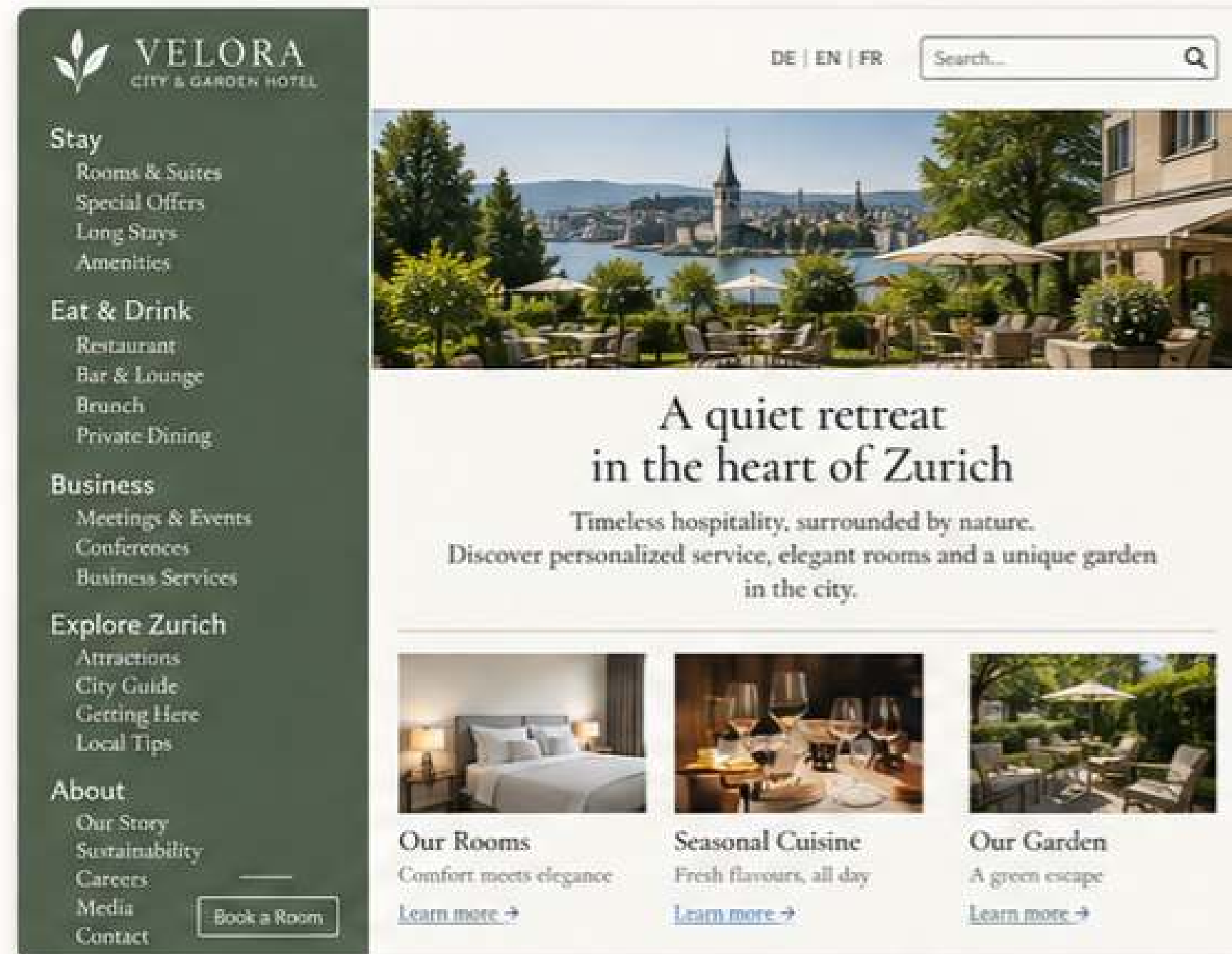


Before / After — Navigation & Booking Flow

Reducing cognitive load and making key actions more accessible.



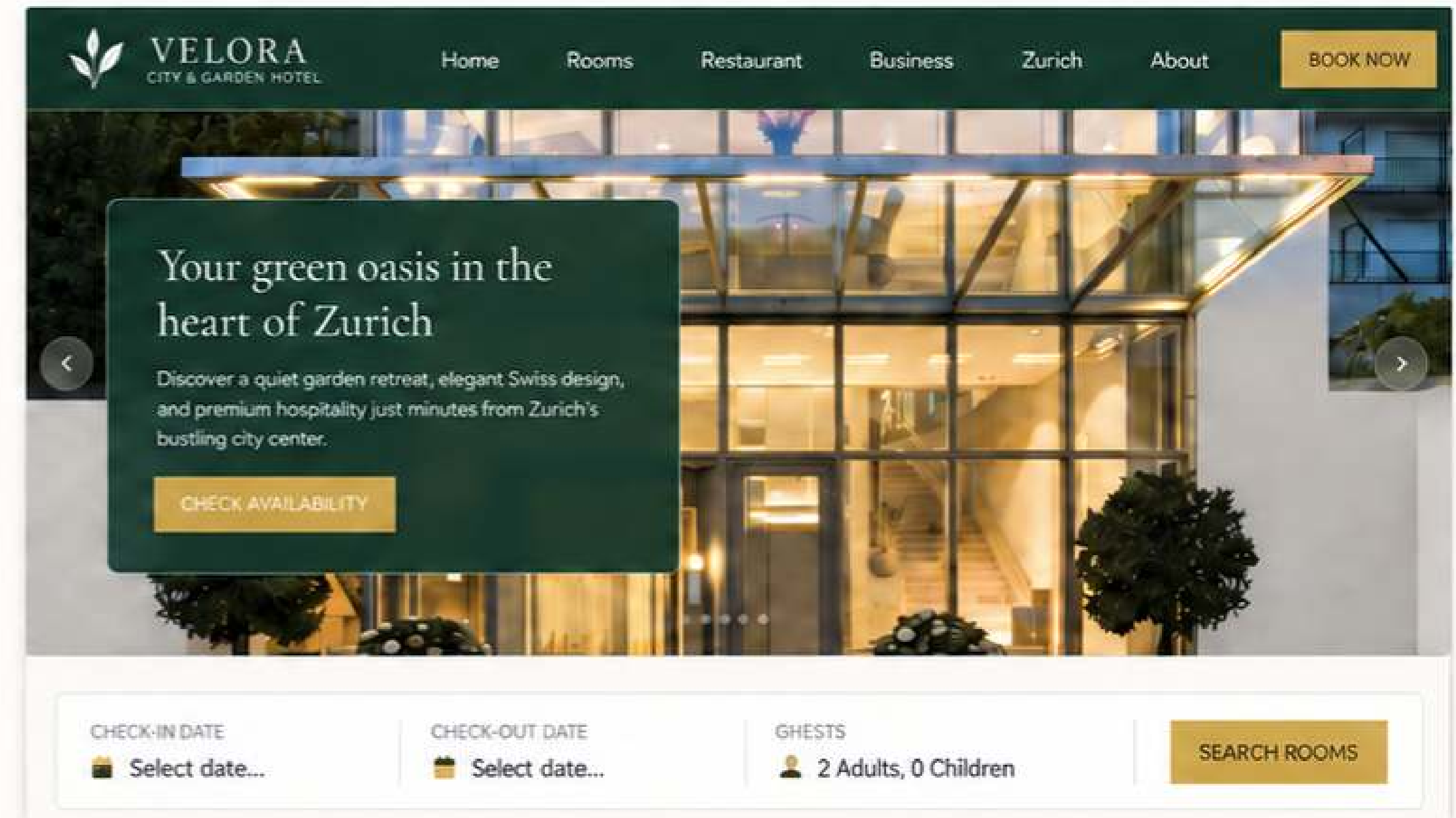
ORIGINAL EXPERIENCE



Before:

- ⊗ Overloaded hamburger menu with too many sections
- ⊗ Key pages hidden behind an extra interaction
- ⊗ Higher cognitive load during exploration
- ⊗ Booking is not integrated into the main journey

REDESIGNED EXPERIENCE



After:

- ✓ Clear and visible primary navigation
- ✓ Faster access to Rooms, Restaurant, Business, and Zurich
- ✓ Reduced friction while browsing
- ✓ Booking begins directly from the hero and booking bar

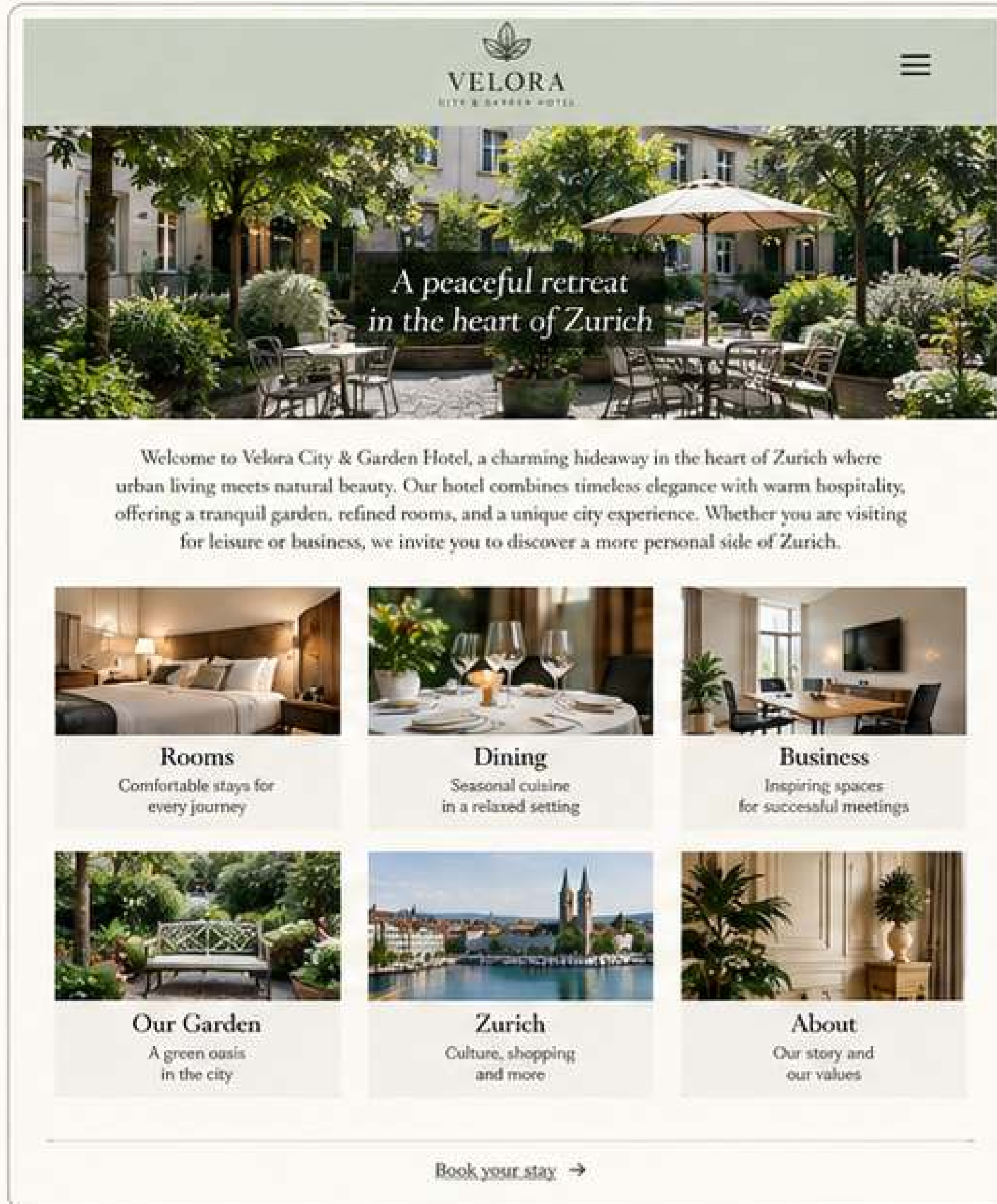


A simpler navigation structure and integrated booking flow create a smoother journey from inspiration to reservation.

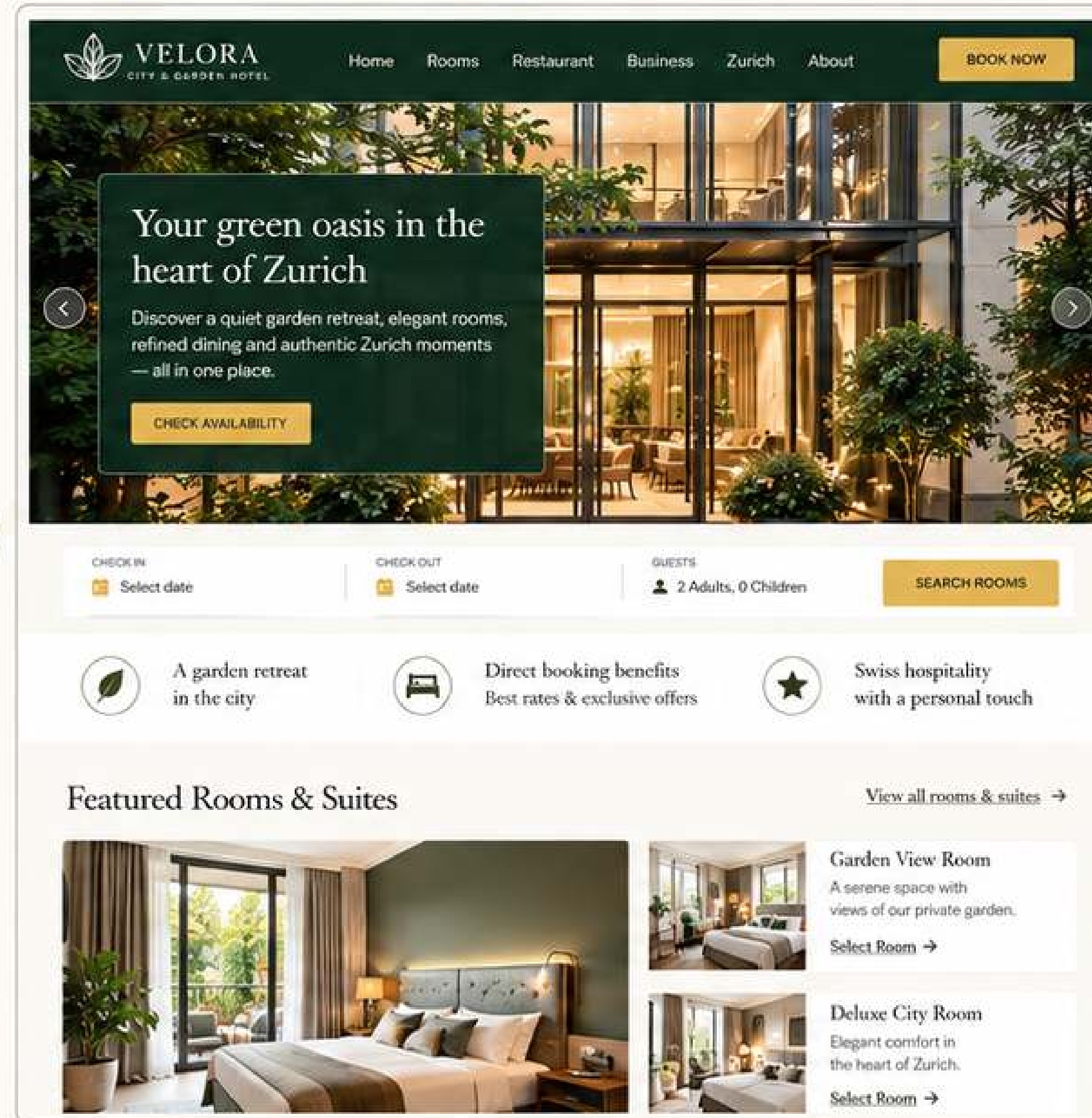
Before / After — Homepage Experience

How the redesign improves clarity, navigation and the path to booking.

ORIGINAL EXPERIENCE



REDESIGNED EXPERIENCE



BEFORE

- Hidden primary navigation
- Booking access feels separated from browsing
- Weak content hierarchy
- Limited guidance toward reservation

AFTER

- Visible top-level navigation
- Booking integrated into the homepage experience
- Clearer visual hierarchy
- Stronger path from exploration to booking



From a visually elegant but fragmented experience to a clearer homepage with stronger hierarchy, visible navigation and direct booking entry points.

Before / After — Rooms Discovery

Clarifying the room offering and making categories easier to explore.



ORIGINAL EXPERIENCE



Our Rooms

A peaceful stay in the heart of the city



At Velora City & Garden Hotel we offer a selection of comfortable rooms and suites designed for a relaxing stay. Whether you're travelling for business or leisure, you'll find a welcoming space with modern amenities and a calm atmosphere inspired by our garden surroundings.



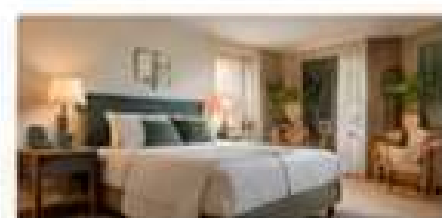
Classic Room



Comfort Room



Superior Room



Relax Suite



Family Room

[Book your stay](#) →



REDESIGNED EXPERIENCE



Room Categories

FIVE WAYS TO FEEL AT HOME



Classic Room

A stylish and comfortable retreat for city explorers.

[View Details](#) →



Comfort Room

More space to unwind after a day in Zurich.

[View Details](#) →



Superior Room

Elevated comfort with beautiful views.

[View Details](#) →



Relax Suite

A spacious suite for rest and renewal.

[View Details](#) →



Family Room

Thoughtful space for families to reconnect.

[View Details](#) →

BEFORE

- Room access is hidden behind the hamburger menu
- Sparse page structure and weak hierarchy
- Room categories feel less discoverable
- Limited guidance toward comparison and selection

AFTER

- Dedicated Rooms page with visible navigation
- Stronger hero and clearer page context
- Booking entry point integrated into the page
- Category cards support faster scanning and comparison

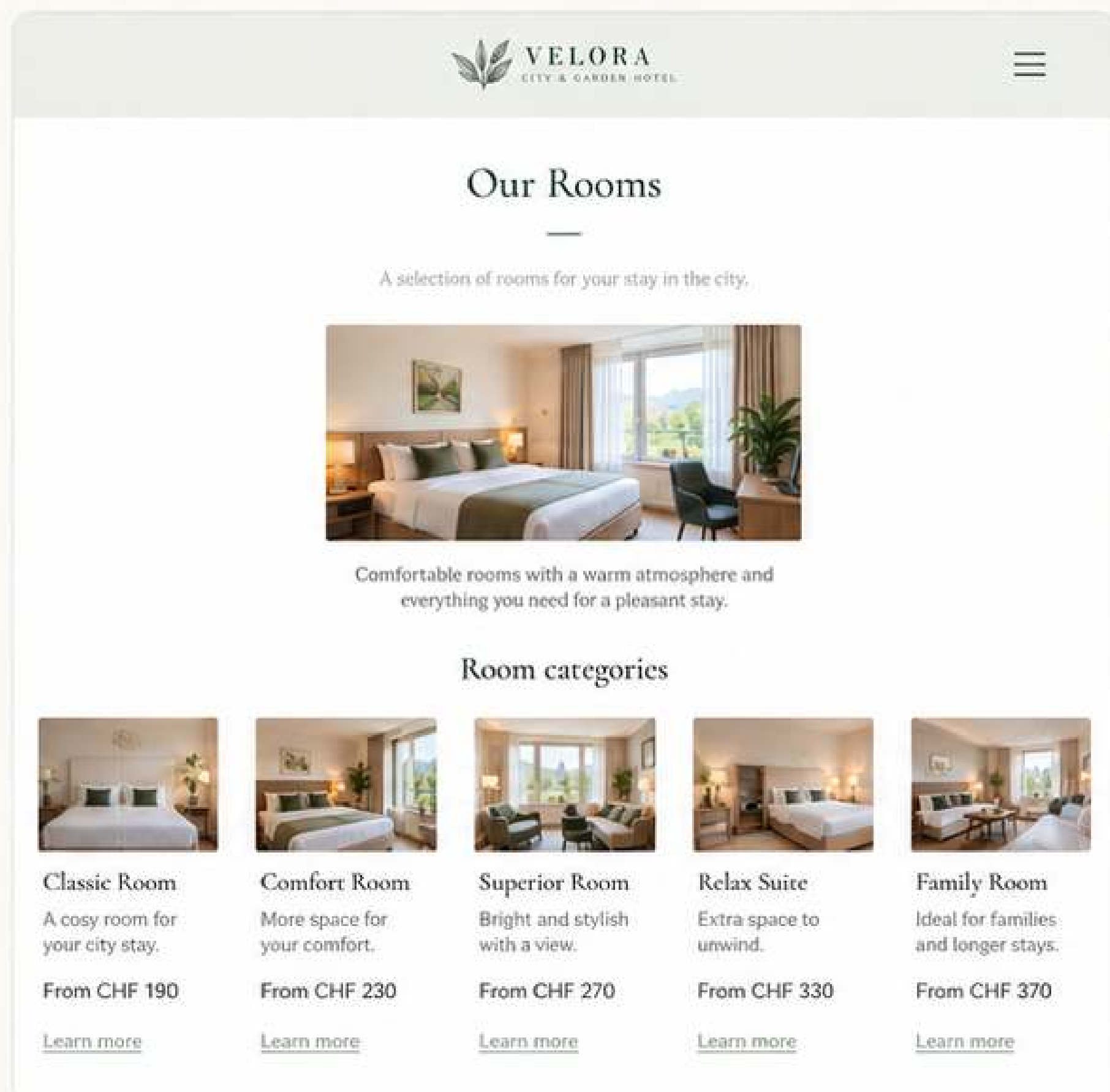


The redesigned Rooms experience improves discoverability, strengthens hierarchy and helps guests move from exploration to selection with less friction.

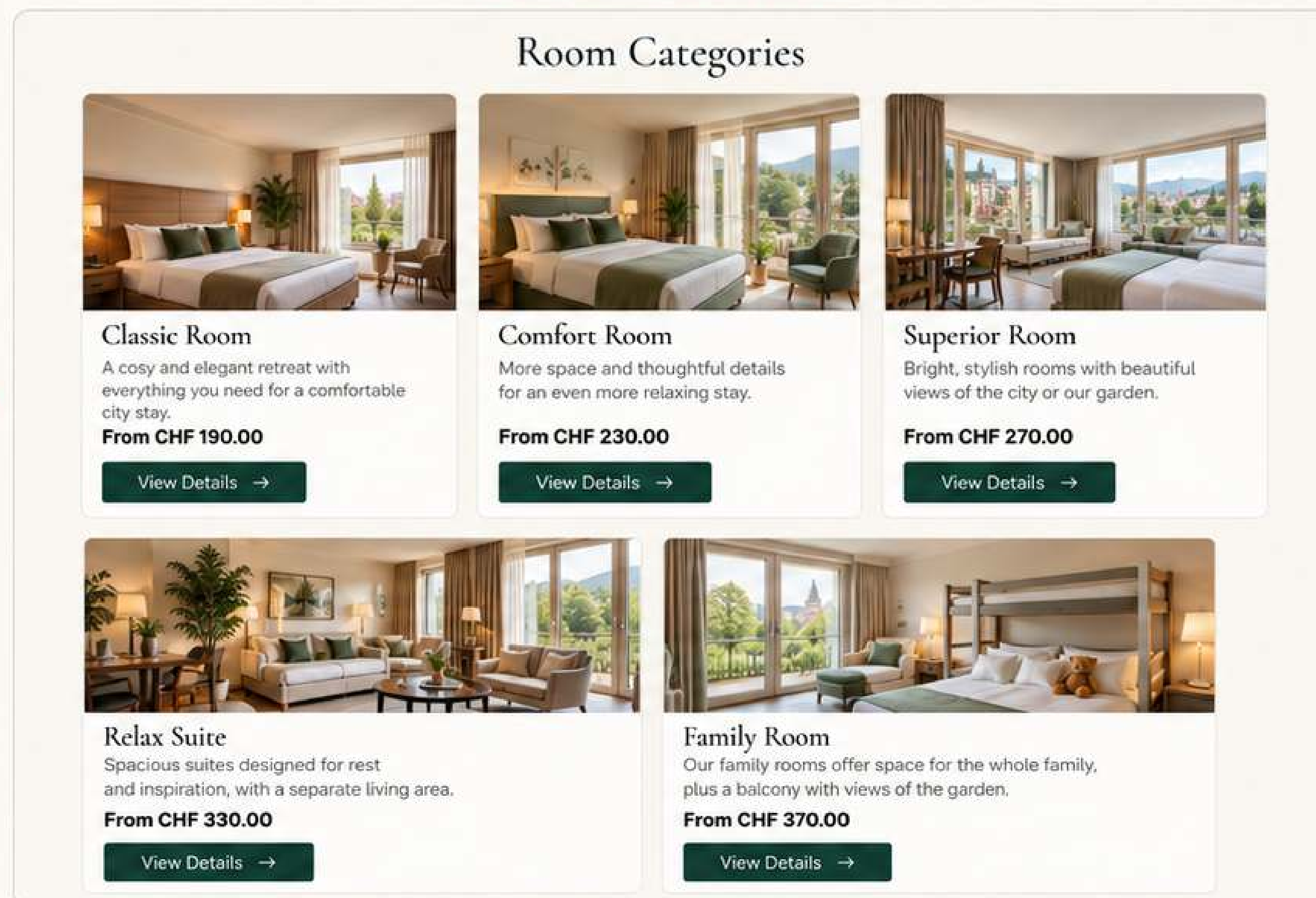
Before / After — Room Categories & Selection

From a minimal listing to a more informative and conversion-oriented browsing experience.

ORIGINAL EXPERIENCE



REDESIGNED EXPERIENCE



BEFORE

- Small room cards with low visual emphasis
- Limited information density for each option
- Weaker prioritization of price and call to action
- Fewer cues to support decision-making



AFTER

- Larger and more consistent room cards
- Clearer hierarchy for name, description, price and CTA
- Easier comparison across room types
- Stronger path from browsing to room detail and booking



By improving the room card system and category presentation, the redesign makes the offer easier to scan, compare and act on.

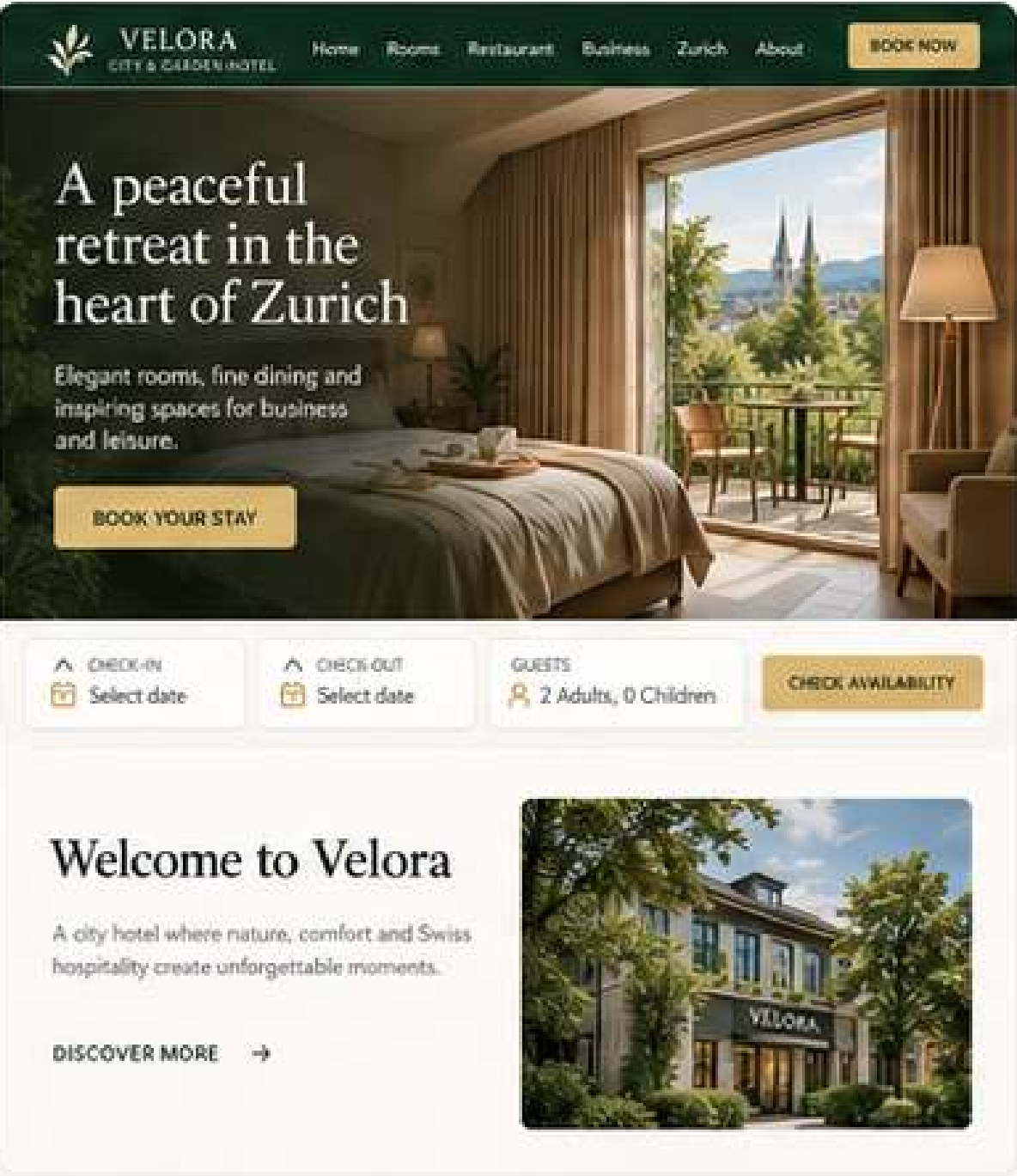
Final Experience — Key Screens

The final experience brings together clearer navigation, stronger content hierarchy and a more confident path to booking across the hotel website.



1 HOMEPAGE

Clear value proposition, intuitive navigation and a visible booking entry point.



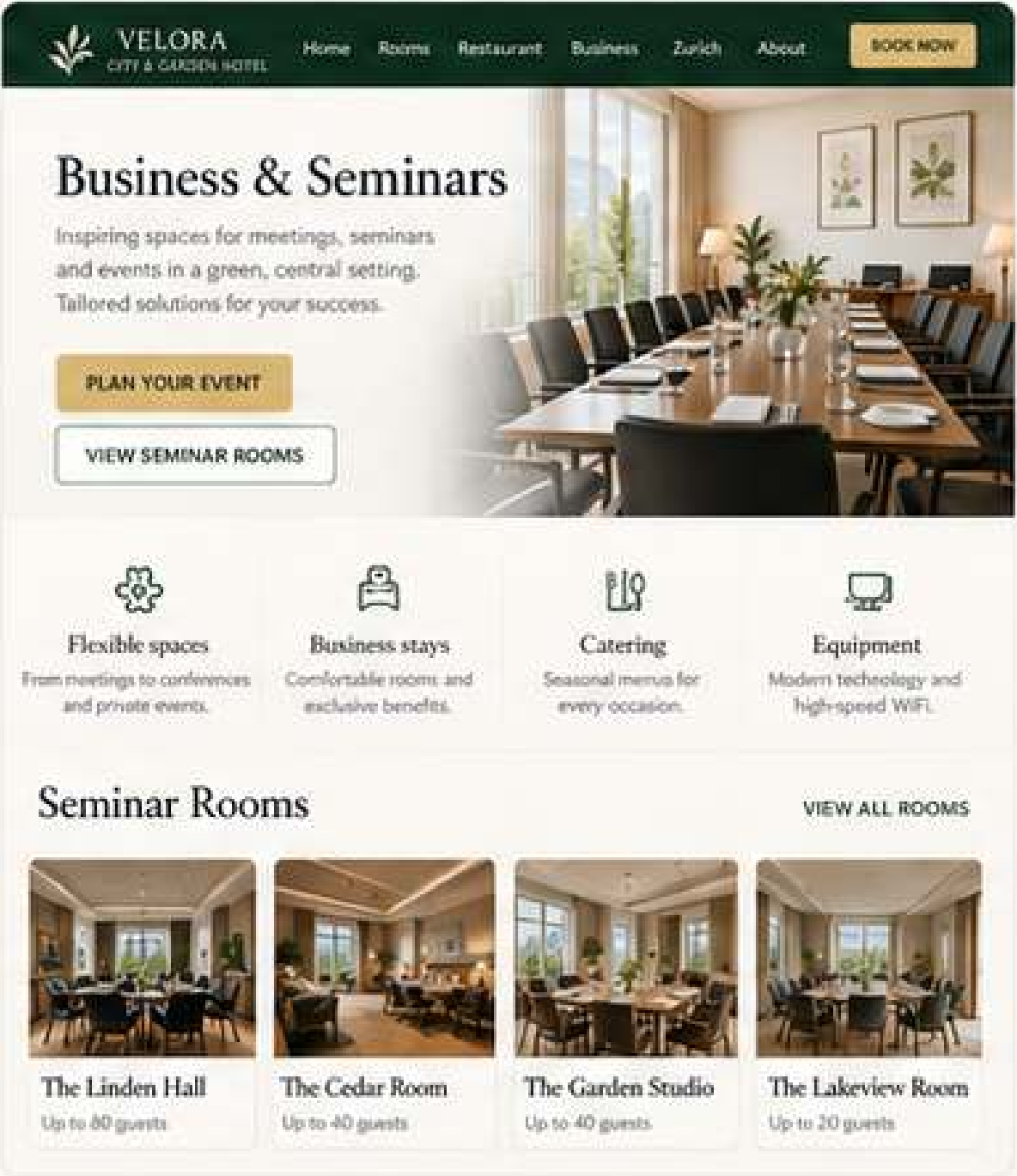
2 ROOMS & SUITES

Easier room discovery with clear categories, filters and detailed information.



3 BUSINESS & SEMINARS

Structured content for events, seminars and business stays.



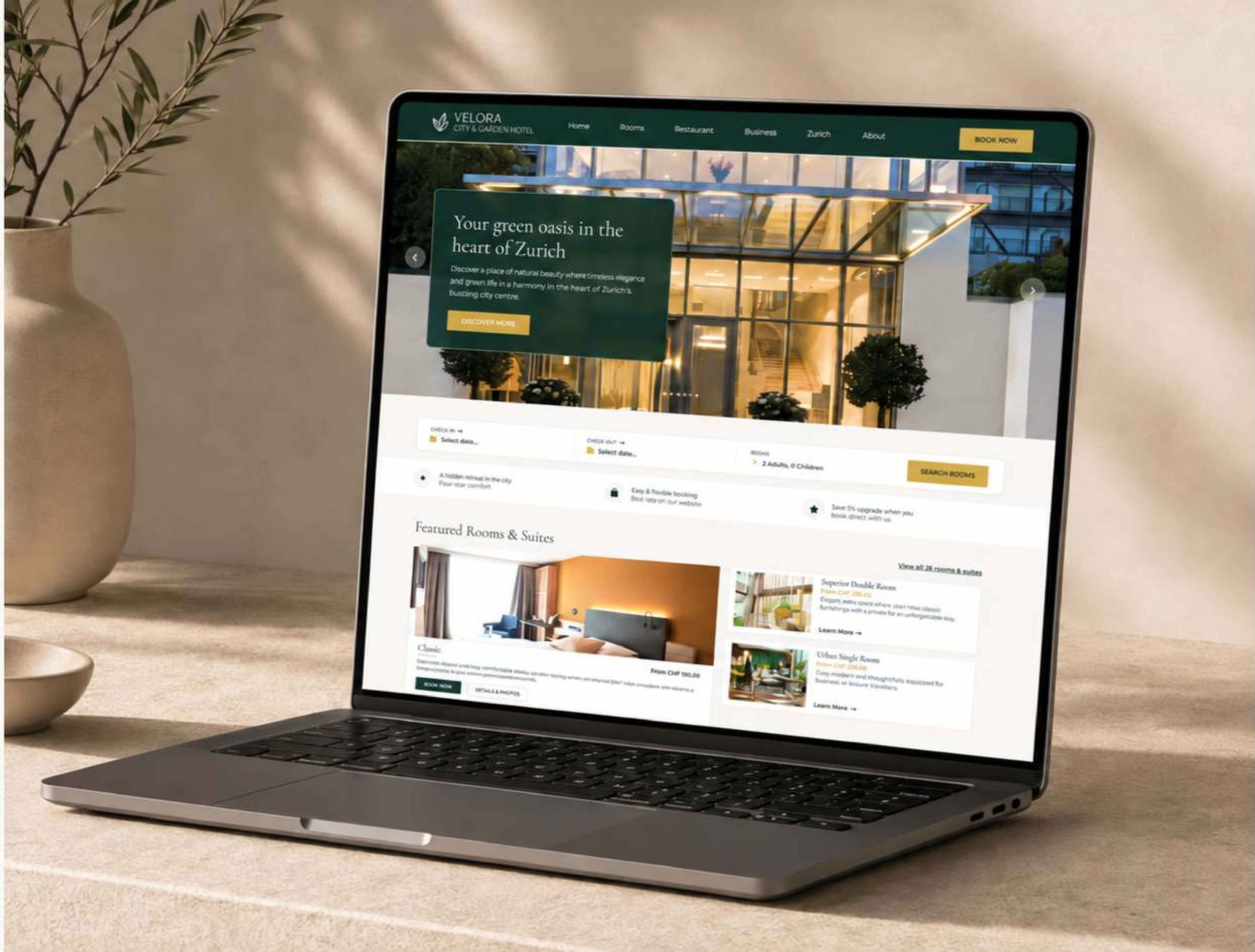
4 RESTAURANT

Highlighting the dining experience with clear information and easy actions.



KEY TAKEAWAY: The redesigned experience simplifies navigation, highlights what matters most and guides guests seamlessly to booking.





DESIGN SYSTEM

A design system to create a consistent, elegant and premium experience across Velora digital products.

01. COLORS

BRAND / PRIMARY

brand/700
#0F3D35

brand/600
#145044

brand/500
#1E6657

ACCENT / GOLD

accent/500
#D4AF37

accent/400
#E0BESA

accent/100
#F6E7B0

NEUTRALS

neutral/ivory
#F7F5EF

neutral/warm-white
#FCF8F8

neutral/sand
#E8E2D7

neutral/stone
#D6CEC1

TEXT COLORS

text/primary
#1E1E1A

text/secondary
#5F8258

text/tertiary
#8A8D84

text/inverse
#FFFFFF

BORDERS & SURFACES

border/subtle
#E8E2D7

border/medium
#CFC8BA

surface/white
#FFFFFF

surface/soft
#F3EFEB

02. TYPOGRAPHY

H1 Heading

Playfair Display
48 / 56 - Regular

H2 Heading

Playfair Display
32 / 40 - Regular

H3 Heading

Playfair Display
24 / 32 - Regular

Body Large

Discover a quiet garden retreat with Swiss hospitality in the heart of Zurich.

Inter
16 / 24 - Regular

Body

Our hotel offers modern comfort, a tranquil garden and exceptional service.

Inter
14 / 22 - Regular

Small / Caption

Some description goes here.

Inter
12 / 16 - Regular

03. SPACING SYSTEM

Base unit: 8px



04. RADIUS & SHADOW

Border Radius



Shadows



05. BUTTONS

	PRIMARY	SECONDARY	TERTIARY (TEXT)
Default	<button>BOOK NOW</button>	<button>CHECK AVAILABILITY</button>	LEARN MORE →
Hover	<button>BOOK NOW</button>	<button>CHECK AVAILABILITY</button>	LEARN MORE →
Pressed	<button>BOOK NOW</button>	<button>CHECK AVAILABILITY</button>	LEARN MORE →
Disabled	<button>BOOK NOW</button>	<button>CHECK AVAILABILITY</button>	LEARN MORE →
Icon button	<button></button> <button></button> <button></button> <button></button>		

06. FORM ELEMENTS

Text input	Your name
Date field	Check-in date
Select	2 Adults, 0 Children
Dropdown	Room type
Checkbox	☒ I agree with the terms and conditions
Radio	☒ Standard rate ☐ Non-refundable rate
Switch	☒

07. CARDS

ROOM CARD



Superior Double Room

24 m² • 2 Guests • King Bed

From CHF 280 / night

[VIEW ROOM →](#)

EXPERIENCE CARD



Garden & Terrace

Relax in our lush garden and enjoy the peaceful atmosphere.

[LEARN MORE →](#)

INFO CARD



Sustainable Hospitality

[Learn more →](#)



Central Location

[Learn more →](#)



Guest Reviews

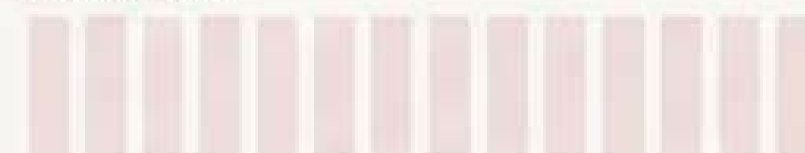
[Learn more →](#)

08. ICONS



09. GRID

12 Column Grid



10. USAGE EXAMPLE (CTA IN CONTEXT)

CHECK-IN 12 May 2025	CHECK-OUT 14 May 2025	GUESTS 2 Adults, 0 Children	<button>SEARCH ROOMS</button>
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PROJECT SCOPE

Focused redesign, scalable system

The redesign focuses on the homepage and key user journeys, supported by representative secondary pages to demonstrate how the proposed design system scales across the experience.

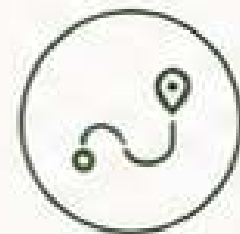


Desktop-first prototype • Key interactions • Representative templates



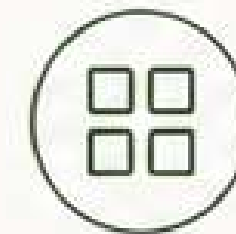
Homepage

Redesigned entry point that communicates value and guides guests to book with confidence.



Key journeys

Streamlined flows for discovery, room selection, and booking built around guest intent.



Scalable templates

Modular page templates and components designed to scale consistently across touchpoints.

— Deliverables Prototype → Interaction flows → Component system → Template library



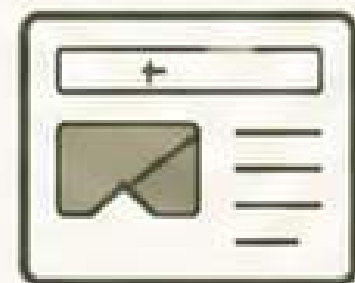
Outcome / Final Takeaway

From a refined but fragmented experience to a clearer, more discoverable and scalable digital journey.



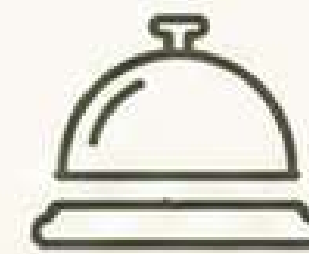
Visible navigation

Core hotel content is easier to discover.



Clearer hierarchy

Guests can scan and compare information faster.



Accessible booking

Booking entry points remain visible throughout exploration.



Scalable system

Reusable components create consistency across the website.

“

The redesign preserves Velora's calm, premium identity while making the experience easier to navigate, easier to understand and more confident to act on.



[View interactive prototype →](#)



Link to Prototype

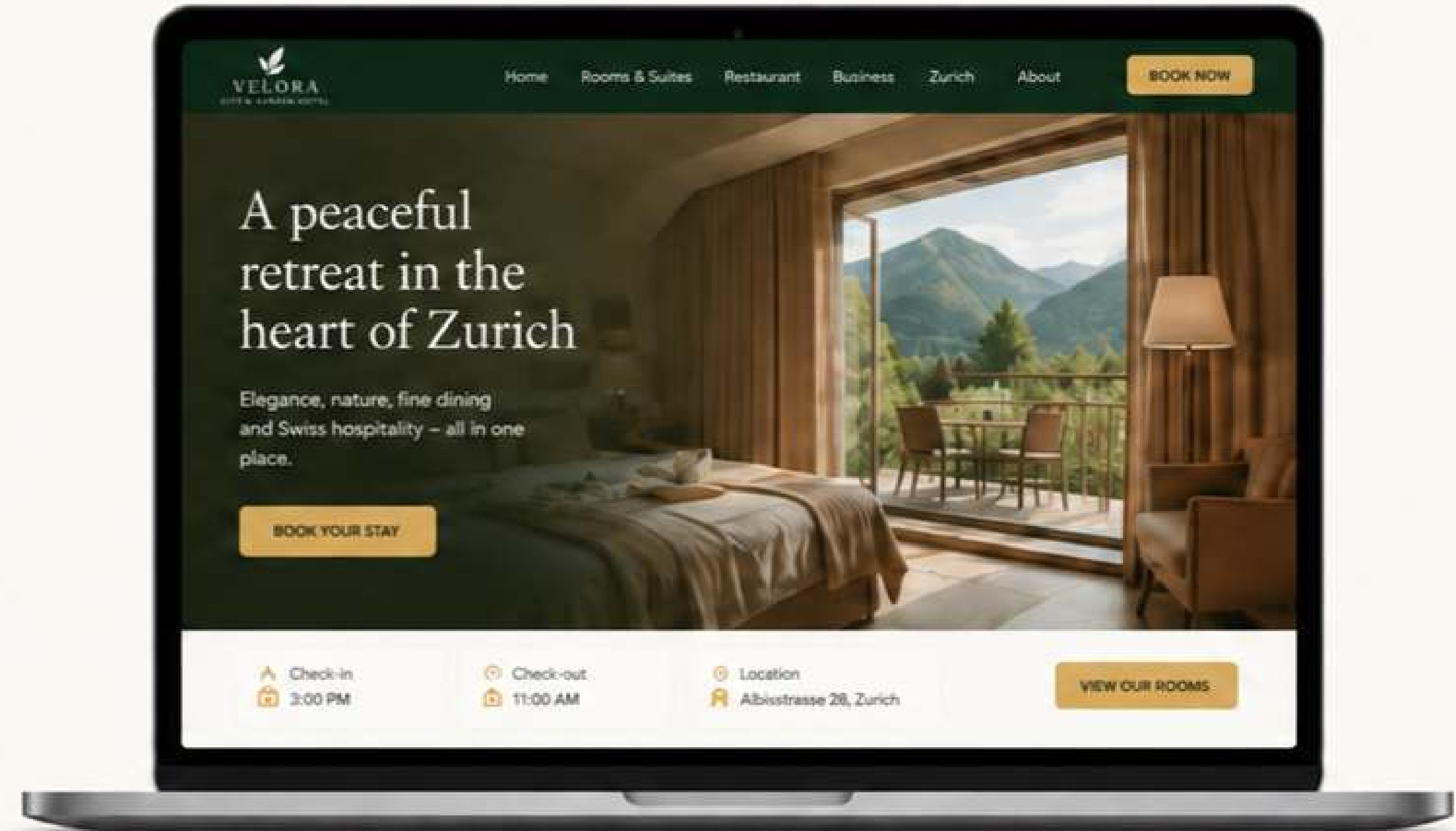
Explore the interactive prototype to experience the redesigned flows and key improvements across the website.



OPEN INTERACTIVE PROTOTYPE



Best experienced in desktop view.



KEY TAKEAWAY: The prototype showcases the final experience, connecting navigation, content and booking entry points.